GUAN-FU CHOU

Ph.D. Student, Center for the Study of Higher and Postsecondary Education
University of Michigan, Ann Arbor

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Education

University of Michigan — Ann Arbor, MI
Ph.D. Student, Higher Education (CSHPE) — *2025 – Present*

- Supervisor: Dr. Jeremy Wright-Kim
- Research Interests: Financial aid policy; postsecondary–labor market alignment; applied causal inference.

National Chengchi University — Taipei, Taiwan
M.A. in Economics — *2024*

- Thesis: *The Effects of College Selectivity and College Location on Wages: A Matching Approach*

National Chengchi University — Taipei, Taiwan
B.Ed. (Minor in Economics); B.A. in Chinese Literature — *2021*

Fellowships and Awards

- Government Scholarship for Study Abroad ($32,000), Ministry of Education, Taiwan 2026
- Ascendium Researcher Fellowship Award, Society for Research on Educational Effectiveness 2026
- Education Policy Initiative (EPI) Predoctoral Fellowship, Gerald R. Ford School of Public Policy, University of Michigan 2026
- Sarri Family Fellowship for Research on Educational Attainment of Youth in Low Income Families, Institute for Social Research ($6,000), University of Michigan 2026
- Rackham ISR Summer Training Award, University of Michigan 2026

Research Experience

University of Michigan, School of Education — Ann Arbor, MI
Graduate Student Research Assistant, Dr. Jeremy Wright-Kim — *Sep 2025 – Present*

- **Project:** Workforce Innovation and Opportunity Act (WIOA) Evaluation.
- Lead the construction of policy-relevant outcome measures capturing postsecondary–labor market alignment, including supply, demand, and alignment outcomes.
- Develop and test multiple definitions of alignment linking associate degree credentials to high-quality, in-demand occupations using IPEDS, Advance CTE crosswalks, MIT Living Wage thresholds, and Bright Outlook Occupations criteria.

National Academy for Educational Research — New Taipei City, Taiwan
Research Assistant — *Oct 2023 – Jul 2025*

- **Projects:** Mental Health, Academic Achievement, and Labor Market Outcomes in Taiwan; Promotion and Improvement of the Yushan Scholars Program.

National Chengchi University — Taipei, Taiwan
Research Assistant — *Jul 2022 – Aug 2023*

Working Papers and Manuscripts Under Review

- Wright-Kim, J., **Chou, G.-F.**, & Leigh, E. W. (2026). *Too Few Good Jobs? Measuring State-Level Labor Market Alignment for Sub-Baccalaureate Credentials.* Under review.
- **Chou, G.-F.**, & Wright-Kim, J. (2026). *Do Neighbors Shape the Sticker Price? Spatial Competition and State Funding in Cost of Attendance Reporting Over Time.* EdWorkingPaper No. 26-1499, Annenberg Institute at Brown University. https://doi.org/10.26300/chfk-a128

Conference Presentations

- Wright-Kim, J., **Chou, G.-F.**, & Leigh, E. W. (2026, November). *Definitions Matter: Are There Enough Good Jobs for Credential Holders Without a Four-Year Degree?* Paper to be presented at the APPAM Fall Research Conference, Boston, MA.
- **Chou, G.-F.** (2026, November). *Unaudited Cost Reporting in Higher Education: Spatial Competition and Consequences for Low-Income Borrowers.* Paper to be presented at the APPAM Fall Research Conference, Boston, MA.
- **Chou, G.-F.**, & Wright-Kim, J. (2026, October). *Cost of Attendance Underreporting: Institutional Discretion, Spatial Patterns, and the Role of State Funding.* Paper to be presented at the ASHE 51st Annual Conference (Virtual Conference Day).
- **Chou, G.-F.**, & Wright-Kim, J. (2026, September). *Do Neighbors Shape the Sticker Price? Spatial Spillovers in Institutional Cost of Attendance Reporting and Student Financial Burden.* Paper to be presented at the SREE 2026 Conference, Baltimore, MD.
- **Chou, G.-F.** (2023, December). *Can attending colleges in the Taipei metropolitan area benefit wages?* Poster presented at the Annual Conference of the Taiwan Economic Association, New Taipei City, Taiwan.

Teaching Experience

National Chengchi University Taipei, Taiwan
Teaching Assistant *2022 – 2024*

- Economics in Everyday Life (Fall 2023); Economics (Spring 2023); Microeconomics (Fall 2022, Fall 2023)

Skills

- **Statistical Software:** Stata, R, Python, SPSS.
- **Methods:** Causal inference, panel data analysis, matching estimators, spatial econometrics, multilevel modeling.

Affiliations

- Association for Education Finance and Policy (AEFP)
- Association for Public Policy Analysis and Management (APPAM)
- Association for the Study of Higher Education (ASHE)
- Society for Research on Educational Effectiveness (SREE)
- American Economic Association (AEA)